

Ris Swank

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Education

Washington State University PhD, Political Science	Expected May 2028
Washington State University MA, Political Science	2025
University of Essex MA, Jungian and Post-Jungian Studies	2018
Seattle University BA, Psychology	2016

Research Interests

Conspiracies, political violence, democracy, far-right movements, masculinity, American politics

Working Papers

- “Detecting conspiratorial rhetoric across violent and non-violent users on a white supremacist forum”
- “Conspiratorial rhetoric in American campaign advertisements”
- “Implicit or explicit? Examining antisemitism and conspiracy belief” with Olyvia Christley and Jacob Lewis
- “Vague or specific: does the wording of conspiracy theories impact political outcomes?” with Olyvia Christley and Jacob Lewis
- “Democratic disaffection and support for political violence” with Marie Fester and Liliana Mason

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- “Facing Death, Returning to Life: A Qualitative Analysis of MDMA-assisted Therapy for Anxiety Associated with Life-threatening Illness.” (2022). *Frontiers in Psychiatry*. With Will Barone, Michiko Mitsunaga-Whitten, Lia Osunfunlayo, Phillip Perl, and Cody Swift.
- “Mercurius Ubiquitous: A Jungian Approach to Psychedelic Therapy.” (2021). *International Journal of Jungian Studies*.

Teaching Experience

Instructor

- POL_S 317 – Media and Politics
- POL_S 101 – American National Government
- POL_S 333 – Development of Marxist Thought

Teaching Assistant

- POL_S 455 – The Presidency
- POL_S 101 – American National Government
- PHIL 103 – Introduction to Ethics
- POL_S 317 – Media and Politics
- PHIL 101 – Introduction to Philosophy

Conferences & Presentations

- “Implicit or explicit? Examining antisemitism and conspiracy belief.” (2026). APSA Annual Meeting
- “Two pathways to supporting political violence: Moral and conspiratorial framing.” (2025). APSA Annual Meeting.
- “Political violence and conspiracy theories.” (2025). Political Communication Preconference.
- “The Great Replacement: A grounded theory study of radicalization in Western democracies.” (2025). WPSA Annual Meeting.

Methods Training & Skills

- Computational Social Science, SICSS, Summer 2026
- Categorical & Ordinal Data, ICPSR, Summer 2025
- ED_PSYCH 575 – Multilevel Modeling, Spring 2025
- POL_S 504 – Quantitative Methods in Political Science, Spring 2024
- POL_S 503 – Qualitative Methods in Political Science, Fall 2023

Additional skills:

MAXQDA, NVivo, R, grounded theory, interpretive phenomenological analysis, content analysis, computational methods for social science research

Professional Experience

Editorial Assistant, *Political Communication*

July 2026 - present

Teaching Assistant, Washington State University

August 2023 - present

Research Assistant, Democracy and Division Lab, SNF Agora Institute

May 2026 – August 2026

Program Manager, Disabled Students Navigating STEM

August 2020 – June 2023

Qualitative Researcher, Riverstyx Foundation

January 2017 – October 2022

Service

Preconference Organizer, APSA Political Psychology Section
July 2025 - present

President, PPPA Graduate Student Association, Washington State University
August 2024 – June 2025

Awards & Grants

Foley Graduate Summer Fellowship, 2026 (\$2,000)

Charles H. Sheldon Graduate Fellowship, 2026 (\$2,500)

Claudius O. and Mary W. Johnson Graduate Fellowship in Political Science, 2025, (\$2,000)

Lovrich Research Fund, 2024, (\$2,000)

Scholarship Award Winner for Best Article Published, 2021, *International Journal of Jungian Studies*